kármán

Karman Labs
Project: HAVOC
Type: Brief
Compiled: Charles Kahn
Date: Jan 8, 2026

Folder: Engineering → Guidance

Analytics & Relationship Intelligence
Vendor Value Index (VVI) Product & Technical Brief

*Brio's VVI turns raw transaction data into an interpretable signal about relationship importance without forcing users into dashboards or spreadsheets.*

# Background / Why?

In the midmarket, analytics are generally back office tools. It's unusual for the sales person to have direct insight into a Vendor's performance from a contextual standpoint (I.e how Vendor A compares to the rest of the cohort).

By owning the POS, Brio also owns a wide scope of analytics data that is challenging to compile in siloed BI tools. Most BI tools rely on connected sources and manual rep reporting. They are overly complex and are primarily used for retrospective questions after the fact/outside the workflow. In Brio, analytics sit directly inside the order flow, where decisions are made in real time. This gives users fast, contextual relationship intelligence at the exact moment they are interacting with an order or vendor.

The Vendor Value Index (VVI) is a simple communication tool designed to bring performance metrics upstream in a set of simple, and easy to understand criteria.

- **Relational intelligence**: Users immediately understand how important a vendor relationship is while placing, reviewing (messaging), and fulfilling orders.
- **Upstream analytics**: Instead of exporting data to BI, core insights live within the relationship (reps)
- **Transparency**: Suppliers can clearly see which relationships matter most, based on live actual behavior.
- **Ops decision-making**: Helps prioritize attention, service levels, negotiation, and follow-ups.
- **Relationship value vs raw data**: Moves beyond simple revenue or order counts to capture stickiness and consistency which matter far more in the high value/low volume

b2b landscape.

## What is the VVI?

The Vendor Value Index is a normalized score (0–100) that represents how valuable and sticky a vendor relationship is, based on a gradient of historical purchasing and relationship behavior.

This composite signal is designed to answer one question clearly:

**“How important is this vendor relationship, based on how we do business?”**

VVI blends multiple layers of the relationship:

| % | VVI Signals | |
|---|---|---|
| 45 | Share | How much of buyer’s total spend/orders flow through vendor |
| 25 | Time | Length of Relationship |
| 15 | Consistency | How often orders are placed (stickiness) |
| 15 | Economic Significance | Typical order size |

| Distinct Signals | |
|---|---|
| Interaction | How much buyer interacts with vendor (chat, sessions, duration) |
| Share | … |
| AOV | … |
| Etc | … |

Distinct signals, separate from VVI calculation but captured and accessible via analytics dashboard.

# Technicals

### 1. Calculation

- Calculated per buyer <> vendor pair.
- Uses a trailing time window (currently 12mo)
- Score is normalized to a 0-100 scale
- Only active buyers ( with ≥1 order with this vendor in the trailing window) are included in normalization
- Weighted composite model (weights currently: 45/25/15/15).
- Tenure moderates the score so new relationships do not instantly max out

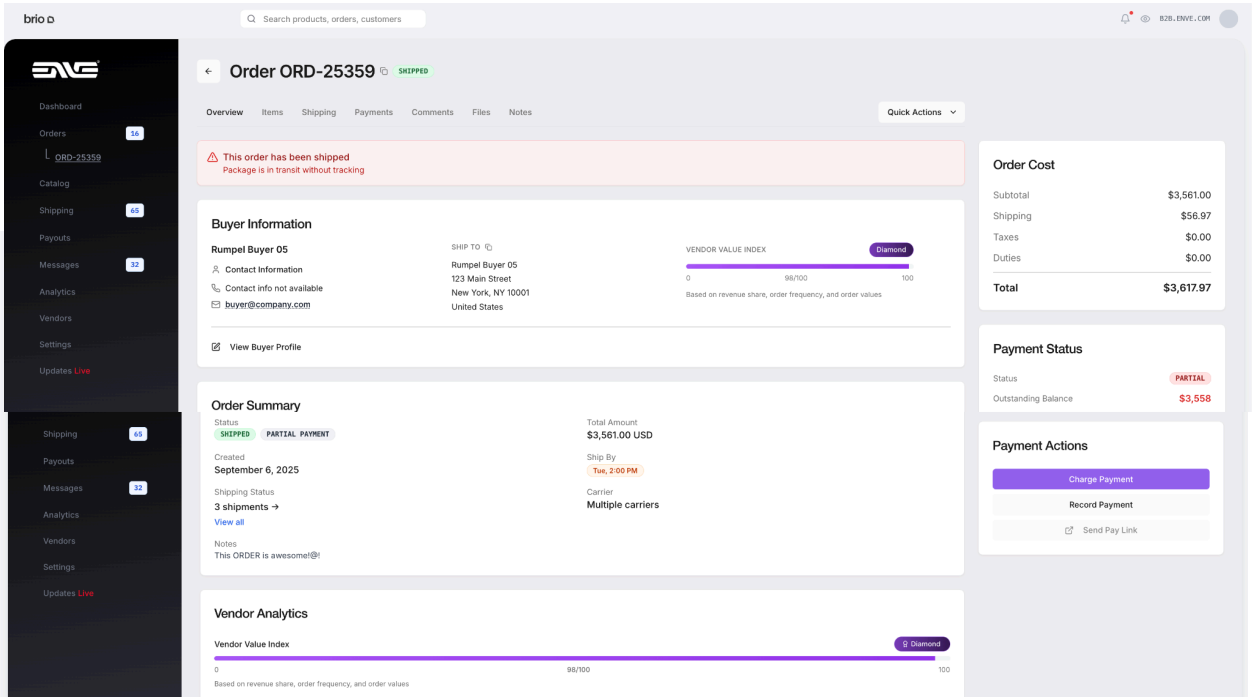
### 2. Levels

- **Bronze**: 0-24
- **Silver**: 25-49
- **Gold**: 50-74
- **Platinum**: 75-89
- **Diamond**: 90-100

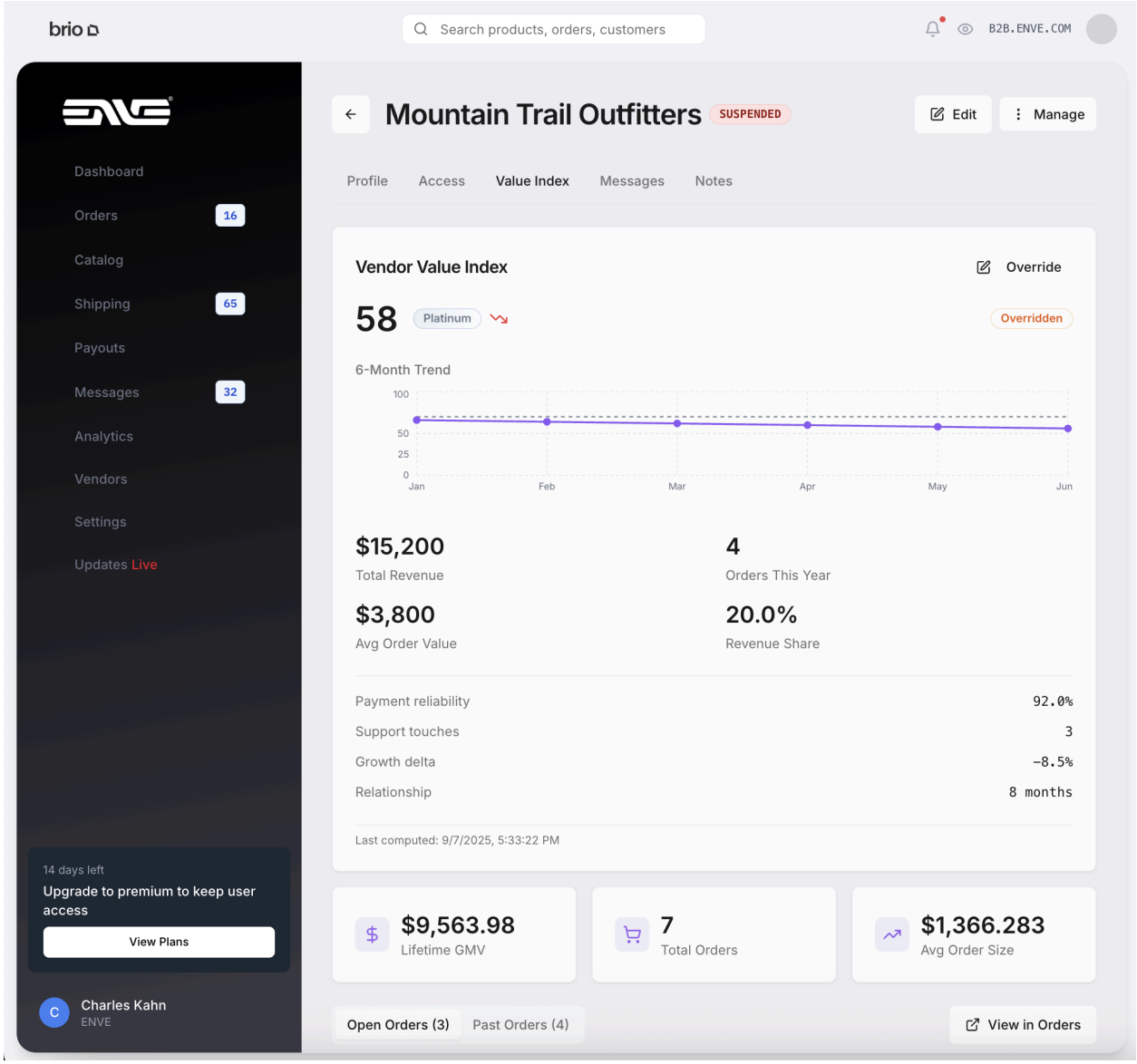
# UX

VVI is surfaced in multiple contexts so it functions as ambient intelligence vs than a hidden metric buried on the analytics tab (it is there too)

- **Inside each order as a simple gauge:** provides immediate context about the vendor while reviewing or fulfilling an order.



- **Vendor account page:** a deeper summary of relationship importance with additional distinct signals.




- **Analytics page:** accessed via analytics page to allow easy comparison across vendors and visual benchmarking. This supports higher level review similar to BI and pattern recognition.

## Summary

VVI is one of the many incremental features that justifies Brio transaction clip. By providing relationship intelligence, Brio can and help sups quickly identify high-value or at risk vendors, and support reps in better nurturing critical accounts.

Longer term, VVI can serve as the foundation for anonymized benchmarking across a cohort o9f suppliers in the same vertical. By aggregating VVI distributions at the supplier level and comparing them against peer cohorts, Brio can help sups understand the relative health of their customer base without exposing buyer-level data. This enables questions like whether a supplier's demand is unusually concentrated, whether their typical buyer is smaller or larger than peers, and whether their customer base is trending healthier or riskier over time. This benchmarking layer would be strictly opt-in, privacy-safe, and positioned as strategic insight built on top of supplier-scoped VVI, not a replacement for it.